Appendix 1. The strings that were used to search in seven different databases (Embase, Medline Ovid, Web of Science Core Collection, Scopus, Med publisher, Cochrane Central Register of Trials and Google scholar)

embase.com (1974-)	777	767
Medline ALL Ovid (1946-)	522	61
Web of Science Core Collection (1900-)	299	34
Cochrane Central Register of Trials (1992-)	64	28
Google scholar	150	20
Total	**1812**	**910**

embase.com

('De Quervain tenosynovitis'/exp OR (((Quervain* OR deQuervain*) NEAR/3 (disease* OR syndrome* OR tend* OR teno* OR thumb* OR first-extensor*)) OR ((Quervain* OR deQuervain*) NOT (thyroid*))):ab,ti) AND ('surgery'/exp OR 'therapy'/exp OR 'surgery':lnk OR 'therapy':lnk OR 'conservative treatment'/exp OR 'injection'/exp OR 'steroid'/exp OR 'splint'/exp OR 'splinting'/exp OR 'clinical trial'/exp OR 'randomization'/exp OR 'intervention study'/exp OR 'cohort analysis'/exp OR 'longitudinal study'/exp OR 'retrospective study'/exp OR 'prospective study'/exp OR 'controlled study'/exp OR (surg* OR operati* OR nonsurg* OR nonoperati* OR conservativ* OR injection* OR steroid* OR corticosteroid* OR splint* OR treatment* OR therap* OR intervention* OR release* OR immobili* OR trial* OR random* OR cohort* OR longitudinal* OR retrospectiv* OR prospectiv* OR management* OR procedure*):ab,ti) NOT ([animals]/lim NOT [humans]/lim) NOT ([Conference Abstract]/lim)

Medline Ovid

(De Quervain Disease/ OR (((Quervain* OR deQuervain*) ADJ3 (disease* OR syndrome* OR tend* OR teno* OR thumb* OR first-extensor*)) OR ((Quervain* OR deQuervain*) NOT (thyroid*))).ab,ti.) AND (exp Surgical Procedures, Operative/ OR exp Therapeutics/ OR surgery.fx. OR therapy.fx. OR exp Conservative Treatment/ OR exp Injections/ OR exp Steroids/ OR exp Splints/ OR exp Clinical Trial/ OR Random Allocation/ OR exp Cohort Studies/ OR Controlled Before-After Studies/ OR (surg* OR operati* OR nonsurg* OR nonoperati* OR conservativ* OR injection* OR steroid* OR corticosteroid* OR splint* OR treatment* OR therap* OR intervention* OR release* OR immobili* OR trial* OR random* OR cohort* OR longitudinal* OR retrospectiv* OR prospectiv* OR management* OR procedure*).ab,ti.) NOT (exp animals/ NOT humans/) NOT (news OR congres* OR abstract* OR book* OR chapter* OR dissertation abstract*).pt.

Web of science Core Collection

TS=((((((Quervain* OR deQuervain*) NEAR/2 (disease* OR syndrome* OR tend* OR teno* OR thumb* OR first-extensor*)) OR ((Quervain* OR deQuervain*) NOT (thyroid*)))) AND ((surg* OR operati* OR nonsurg* OR nonoperati* OR conservativ* OR injection* OR steroid* OR corticosteroid* OR splint* OR treatment* OR therap* OR intervention* OR release* OR immobili* OR trial* OR random* OR cohort* OR longitudinal* OR retrospectiv* OR prospectiv* OR management* OR procedure*)) NOT ((animal* OR rat OR rats OR murine) NOT (human* OR patient*))) AND DT=(article)

Cochrane Central register of Trials

((((Quervain* OR deQuervain*) NEAR/3 (disease* OR syndrome* OR tend* OR teno* OR thumb* OR first-extensor*)) OR ((Quervain* OR deQuervain*) NOT (thyroid*))):ab,ti)

Google scholar

"Quervain|deQuervain disease|syndrome|tendinopathy|tenosynovitis|tendinitis|tendovaginitis" surgery|surgical|operative|nonsurgival|nonoperative|conservative|injection|steroids|corticosteroids|splint|treatment|therapy|intervention|trial|randomization|cohort